

Traditional  
madder red  
colour of British  
uniforms



#### ▲ FRENCH HUSSAR'S PARADE JACKET

**Date** 1871

**Origin** France

**Material** Wool

This lieutenant's jacket is from the 9th Regiment of Hussars in the French army. Right through to 1914, hussar regiments kept a role in the French, British, Russian, and several other European armies. They functioned as light cavalry, and were celebrated for their highly elaborate parade uniforms.

Ornamental  
corded decoration

Spike finial



#### ◀ PRUSSIAN PICKELHAUBE

**Date** 1867

**Origin** Prussia

**Material** Leather

The *Pickelhaube* spiked military helmet was designed in 1842 by King Frederick William IV of Prussia. It was made of boiled leather with metal trim and spike. This 1867 version was worn in the Franco-Prussian War of 1870–71.

Insignia of 4th cavalry  
regiment of Genova



#### ▶ ITALIAN CAVALRY OFFICER'S CAP

**Date** 1876

**Origin** Italy

**Material** Felt, leather

Italy was one of the first countries to move away from wearing brightly coloured uniforms, introducing grey-green ones in 1909 – around the same time that the Russians switched to khaki. This blue cap was worn by a cavalry officer in the late 19th century.

Yellow piping  
matches collar  
and cuffs



#### ▶ ITALIAN CAVALRY FLAG

**Date** c.1880

**Origin** Italy

**Material** Wool

The guidon, or military standard, remained brightly coloured as uniforms became more muted, functioning as a symbol of identity and tradition. This cavalry flag bears the coat of arms of the Italian House of Savoy, which ruled Italy for 85 years from 1861–1946.

Eagle and crest of  
House of Savoy



#### ▲ ITALIAN CAVALRY JACKET

**Date** 1876

**Origin** Italy

**Material** Wool

Until the development of chemical dyes towards the end of the 19th century, many colourful uniforms, such as this elegant blue Italian cavalry jacket, would have been issued in slightly varying shades.